

Abstract

Rabbi Shulman continues an explanation of Hallel (Tehillim 118), focusing on how Hashem elevates the despised “stone” into a “cornerstone,” revealing salvation as overtly miraculous and pre-planned from Creation. He then turns to the pleas of “אֲנֵהּ ה' הוֹשִׁיעָה נָא” and “אֲנֵהּ ה' הַצְלִיחָה נָא” as requests for deliverance from opposition and for continued success. Finally, he offers a striking reading of “אֲסִרוּ חַג בְּעֲבֹתֵי עַד קִרְנוֹת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ” as a call to intensify thanksgiving through עבודת הקרבנות, and notes how the chapter’s closing “הוֹדוּ” mirrors its opening.

I. “רֹאשׁ פִּינָה” — from lowliness to “אָבֵן מַאֲסוֹ הַבּוֹנִים”

A. The added elevation beyond mere salvation

- Rabbi Shulman explains that the phrase conveys an “עוד יתיר מעלה”:
 - Not only was David (or the Jewish people) lifted from **שפלות** and **צער** (as in “הוֹדִיתִנִּי כִּי עָנִיתִנִּי”), but he was elevated to “לְרֹאשׁ פִּנָּה”—a position of central importance.
- The theme is not just rescue from distress, but **promotion to leadership / prominence**.

B. Recognizing the event as supernatural

- “מֵאֵת ה' הִיְתָה זֹאת הִיא נִפְלְאֶת בְּעֵינֵינוּ” (This is from Hashem; it is wondrous in our eyes.)
 - Rabbi Shulman emphasizes: “נִפְלְאֶת” means **not within טבע**; it is recognized as clearly from Hashem.

C. Miracles “hard-coded” into Creation

- Rabbi Shulman explains that Hashem “סִדֵּר זֶה הַיּוֹם מִשְׁשֶׁשֶׁת יְמֵי בְרָאשִׁית”:
 - All miracles that are **מעלה מן הטבע** were already arranged from the **six days of Creation**.
 - He references earlier discussions in sefarim (e.g., *Ner Mitzvah*, *Be'er HaGolah*, *Derech Chaim*) that treat miracles as built into the fabric of creation.

D. Connecting “נִפְלְאֶת” to “זֶה הַיּוֹם עָשָׂה ה'”

- Rabbi Shulman frames the linkage:
 - “זֶה הַיּוֹם עָשָׂה ה' נִגִּילָה וְנִשְׂמְחָה בּוֹ” (This is the day Hashem has made; we will rejoice and be glad in it.)
 - “This day” is not random; it is part of the pre-structured plan from Creation.

E. Rejoicing as fulfillment of purpose

- Rabbi Shulman adds a conceptual layer:
 - When the world (e.g., the sea in Midrashic language) “rejoices,” it means it has reached its **תפקיד**—its intended purpose.
 - Miracles are not a בדיעבד “patch,” but part of how creation fulfills its designed mission.
-

II. “אָנָא ה' הוֹשִׁיעָה נָא / הַצְלִיחָה נָא” — requests for salvation and success (6:01)

A. “הוֹשִׁיעָה נָא” — removing opposition

- Rabbi Shulman explains:
 - “אָנָא ה' הוֹשִׁיעָה נָא” is a plea that there should be **מתנגד** **סו**—no one standing against us, attacking, or causing hardship.

B. “הַצְלִיחָה נָא” — continued growth beyond what we already have

- Rabbi Shulman explains:
 - “אָנָא ה' הַצְלִיחָה נָא” asks Hashem to grant further **הצלחה**—**more than what has been achieved until now**.
-

III. “בְּרוּךְ הַבָּא ... וּבִרְכָנוּכֶם מִבֵּית ה'” — blessing those who come to serve Hashem (7:02)

A. “בְּרוּךְ הַבָּא לַעֲבוּדָתוֹ”

- Rabbi Shulman reads “בְּרוּךְ הַבָּא בְּשֵׁם ה'” (Blessed is the one who comes in the name of Hashem) as:
 - A blessing upon those who **enter** **עבודת ה'**, coming to serve Hashem.

B. “מִבֵּית ה'” as the voice of the כהנים

- Rabbi Shulman explains:
 - “מִבֵּית ה'” (We bless you from the House of Hashem)
 - These are understood as **the words of the כהנים** blessing those who arrive at the **בית המקדש** to do the avodah.

C. Distinction between “ברוך” and “וברכנוכם”

- Rabbi Shulman clarifies the added meaning:
 - “ברוך” implies blessed “in itself.”
 - “וברכנוכם” adds that the person is **fit to be blessed by others**, receiving blessing from the ציבור / those in the Mikdash.
-

IV. “אָסְרוּ חַג בְּעִבְתֵּימָם עַד קַרְנוֹת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ” — intensifying thanks through korbanot (11:00)

A. Thanksgiving expressed not only verbally, but through עבודה

- Rabbi Shulman explains the core idea:
 - This day of miracles warrants **הודאה והלל**, and additionally **לעבוד לפניו**—serving Hashem through korbanot.

B. The verse as a משל: “tie up / encircle the חג” to the altar’s corners

- He reads the pasuk as describing (in metaphorical/avodah terms):
 - Bringing such an abundance of korbanot that the מזבח becomes “bound up” to its corners.

C. Connection to קרנות המזבח הדם on the זריקת הדם

- Rabbi Shulman explains the avodah imagery:
 - Since the blood of certain korbanot is placed on the **קרנות המזבח**, the verse can be read as portraying the “חגיגה” being brought up to the point of the altar’s corners receiving the blood.
- He suggests the picture of “אסרו” as almost like **wrapping/encircling** the corners through repeated זריקות—i.e., a heightened עבודת הקרבנות corresponding to the magnitude of Hashem’s kindness.

D. Not necessarily the simple peshat (and contrast with Rashi)

- Rabbi Shulman notes that Rashi offers peshatim (including the notion of **אסרו חג** as extending celebration with a meal after Yom Tov), but his focus here is on a **conceptual reading** connecting the verse to עבודת הקרבנות as an expression of praise.
-

V. The chapter closes as it began: “הודו לה' כי טוב” (18:06)

A. Structural note: ending with “הודו” mirrors the opening

- Rabbi Shulman points out:
 - “הודו לה' כי טוב כי לעולם חסדו” (Give thanks to Hashem for He is good; His kindness is eternal.)
 - The kapitel begins with הודו and ends with הודו, framing everything as an act of gratitude.

B. The only fitting response to Hashem's good

- Rabbi Shulman explains the emphasis:
 - For all the good Hashem has done, the appropriate response is fundamentally **to thank**—gratitude is what remains in our hands.

C. Transition to Chazal's derashot about David

- Rabbi Shulman begins introducing the Midrashic/Gemara-driven readings:
 - “...רבותינו ז"ל דרשו הכתובים אודך על דוד המלך.”
 - He starts listing attributions such as:
 - “אודך כי עניתני” associated with David
 - “אבן מאסו הבונים” associated with Yishai
 - (This section is opened in the transcript but continues beyond the excerpt provided.)
-

X. In Summary

- Rabbi Shulman presents “אבן מאסו הבונים” as more than rescue: Hashem elevates the downtrodden into “ראש פינה.”
- “מאת ה' היתה זאת... נפלאה” highlights that true redemption is beyond nature and was prepared from Creation.
- “אנא ה' הושיעה נא / הצליחה נא” are framed as pleas for removal of opposition and for ongoing success.
- “ברוך הבא... וברכונם מבית ה'” is read as the כהנים blessing those who enter עבודת ה' in the Mikdash.
- “אסרו חג... עד קרנות המזבח” becomes a call to expand gratitude into הקרבנות—so much avodah that the altar's corners are “bound” through the זריקת הדם.
- The kapitel's ending “הודו” returns to its opening message: the enduring, most fitting response to Hashem's חסד is הודאה.